Candidate Pipeline

📄 Candidate Pipeline

1. Overview

The Candidate Pipeline defines how candidates enter the system, get evaluated, shortlisted, and finally processed for hiring within a requisition.

This pipeline is designed to:

- Handle candidates from multiple sources continuously
- Maintain a global candidate database
- Provide requisition-specific evaluation (ATS view)
- Separate evaluation from execution (shortlisting vs hiring process)

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2. Global Candidate Ingestion

Candidates can enter the system from multiple sources:

- Career Page (public applications)
- LinkedIn
- Naukri or other job platforms
- Manual entry by HR/TA
- Bulk upload

When a candidate is received:

1. The system checks for duplicates using:
    - Email
    - Resume content (if available)

2. If the candidate does not exist:
    - A new record is created in the global **candidates** table
3. If the candidate already exists:
    - The existing record is reused
    - Source information may be updated or appended
4. The system records:
    - Candidate details (name, email, phone)
    - Source (LinkedIn, Career Page, Manual, etc.)
    - Resume and metadata
    - Timestamp of entry

3. Application Creation (Requisition Linking)

After storing the candidate globally, the system creates an **application** linked to a specific requisition.

Key points:

- One candidate can apply to multiple requisitions
- Each application is independent
- All pipeline actions (stage, shortlist, etc.) are handled at the **application level**, not candidate level

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4. Requisition-Level Candidate View (ATS)

Each requisition displays only the candidates who applied to it.

Example:

- Global candidates: 5000
- Candidates applied to REQ-5: 400

The ATS view for REQ-5 will show only those 400 candidates.

Important rule:

- The system must always fetch candidates via the **applications table**
- Direct querying of the global candidates table for ATS view is not allowed

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5. Candidate Evaluation (Ranking)

When a candidate is linked to a requisition:

1. The system parses the resume and extracts structured data
2. The ranking engine calculates scores using:
    - Keyword matching
    - Semantic matching
    - Business signals
    - ATS rule-based logic
    - AI evaluation
3. The final score is computed and stored
4. The system assigns an **ATS bucket** based on the score

All scores are:

- Precomputed
- Stored in the database
- Not recalculated during UI rendering

6. ATS Bucket Classification

Candidates are grouped into buckets for easier evaluation:

- BEST
- VERY GOOD
- GOOD
- AVERAGE
- NOT SUITABLE

Buckets are derived from the final score and stored at the application level.

Purpose:

- Simplify comparison
- Help HR/TA quickly identify strong candidates
- Avoid manual filtering

7. ATS View (Evaluation Layer)

The ATS view is presented in a Kanban-style layout based on buckets.

Characteristics:

- Displays candidates grouped by quality (bucket)
- Used only for evaluation and decision-making
- Shows ranking insights and candidate summaries

Restrictions:

- No interview actions are performed here
- No hiring actions are performed here

8. Shortlisting (Decision Step)

Shortlisting is the key transition from evaluation to execution.

When HR/TA shortlists a candidate:

- The application stage is updated to **SHORTLISTED**
- The candidate is Visible to ATS bucket view
- The candidate is moved to the shortlisted section

Important:

- Shortlisting is done per application (not per candidate globally)
- A candidate can be shortlisted in one requisition and not in another

9. Shortlisted Candidates Section (Execution Layer)

This section contains only shortlisted candidates for a requisition.

Purpose:

- Provide a clean workspace for hiring actions
- Remove noise from ATS evaluation data

Available actions:

- Schedule interviews
- Send emails (individual or bulk)
- Assign interview panels
- Move candidates to next stages

10. Interview and Hiring Flow

Once a candidate is shortlisted:

1. Interview is scheduled by HR/TA
2. Interviewers are assigned
3. Candidate attends interview
4. Feedback is collected
5. Candidate is moved to:
    - Next round
    - Rejected
    - Offer stage

Final outcomes:

- HIRED
- REJECTED

11. Continuous Candidate Handling

The system supports continuous candidate inflow.

When new candidates arrive:

- They are stored in the global database
- Applications are created
- Ranking is triggered automatically
- Buckets are assigned
- Candidates appear in the ATS view without affecting existing data

12. Key Rules and Constraints

- Candidates are stored globally; applications are requisition-specific
- All stages and actions are handled at the application level
- Scores are precomputed and stored; no runtime recalculation
- Buckets are assigned in the backend, not in the frontend
- ATS view is for evaluation only; pipeline is for execution
- A candidate can exist in multiple requisitions independently

13. Edge Case Handling

- Duplicate candidates are merged based on email or resume
- Duplicate applications for the same requisition should be prevented or handled explicitly
- Candidates applying from multiple sources are unified under one profile
- Missing candidate data should not block the pipeline; partial evaluation is allowed
- New candidates should always be evaluated using the latest ranking logic

14. Summary

The Candidate Pipeline is structured into three clear layers:

1. Data Layer
    - Candidate storage and application linkage

2. Evaluation Layer
    - Ranking and bucket-based ATS view
3. Execution Layer
    - Shortlisting, interviews, and hiring

This separation ensures the system remains scalable, understandable, and efficient for real-world hiring operations.